

Human Resources Policy

Working hours, leave, parental leave & probation

Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes Acme Corp's standards for working hours, attendance, annual leave, parental leave, and the probationary period for new hires. It applies to all full-time employees across all departments and is intended to ensure consistent, fair, and predictable application of core employment terms company-wide.

Definitions

Core Hours	The window (9:00 AM–5:00 PM) during which employees are expected to be present and available, absent an approved flextime arrangement.
Accrual	The gradual build-up of annual leave entitlement over the course of the calendar year, rather than a lump-sum grant.
Qualifying Event	The birth of a child, or placement of a child through adoption or foster care, which triggers eligibility for Parental Leave.
Probation	A defined evaluation period at the start of employment during which performance and cultural fit are formally assessed.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Submit leave requests on time, maintain agreed working hours, and raise questions about eligi
Direct Manager	Approve or decline flextime and leave requests, monitor attendance, and conduct probation ch
Department Head	Provide final approval on annual leave requests and ensure team coverage during absences.
HR Team	Maintain policy documentation, confirm parental leave eligibility, and administer probation and

1. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours at Acme Corp are from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday through Friday, totaling 40 hours per week. All employees are expected to be present and available during core business hours, whether working on-site or remotely.

Attendance is tracked through the HR Portal's time and attendance module. Employees are expected to log in and out consistently with their agreed schedule so that department staffing levels remain predictable.

Flextime schedules may be approved by direct managers, provided they do not affect department performance. Requests should be discussed directly with the employee's manager and documented for HR records so that expectations are clear to both parties.

- Flextime arrangements are reviewed periodically and may be adjusted if department needs change.
- Persistent unapproved deviation from agreed hours may be addressed through the normal performance management process.

2. Annual Leave & Paid Time Off

Employees are entitled to 25 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues monthly at a rate of 2.08 days per month, meaning employees build up entitlement gradually rather than receiving the full balance at the start of the year.

This gradual accrual model means employees who join partway through the year receive a pro-rated entitlement based on their start date, while employees who leave the company will have their final balance calculated on the same accrual basis.

- Vacation requests must be submitted through the HR Portal at least two weeks in advance.
- All requests require approval from the department head before leave is confirmed.
- A maximum of 5 unused leave days can be carried over into the following calendar year; any balance beyond this is forfeited unless otherwise agreed with HR.
- Managers are encouraged to review team leave balances quarterly to help employees plan ahead and avoid a year-end backlog of unused days.

3. Paid Parental Leave

Acme Corp provides up to 12 weeks of fully paid Parental Leave to eligible employees following the birth of a child, or the placement of a child in connection with adoption or foster care.

This policy applies equally to all new parents, regardless of gender, in support of family bonding during a child's first year and reflects Acme Corp's commitment to equitable family support across all employee groups.

- Parental leave must be taken within the first 12 months after the qualifying event (birth, adoption, or foster placement).

- Leave may be taken continuously or, where operationally feasible, in agreed blocks within the 12-month window, subject to manager and HR agreement.

■ Eligibility Note

Employees should confirm eligibility requirements and required documentation with HR as early as possible once a qualifying event is anticipated, to allow time for handover planning and coverage arrangements.

4. Probationary Period

All new hires undergo a standard probationary period of 6 months. During this time, performance and alignment with company values are formally evaluated by the employee's manager through regular check-ins and at least one formal review.

The probationary period is intended to give both the employee and Acme Corp a fair opportunity to assess fit before the employment relationship is confirmed on a standard ongoing basis.

- Either party may terminate the employment contract during probation with a 1-week notice period.
- Managers should document probation check-ins in the HR Portal to maintain a clear record of performance discussions.

Standard Procedure — Requesting Annual Leave

- 1 Log in to the HR Portal and navigate to the Leave Management section.
- 2 Select the desired dates and confirm the remaining leave balance is sufficient.
- 3 Submit the request at least two weeks before the intended start date.
- 4 Notify your direct manager separately if the leave affects an active project or deliverable.
- 5 Await approval from your department head; the status will update in the HR Portal.
- 6 Once approved, set up any necessary handover notes or out-of-office coverage before departure.

Frequently Asked Questions

What happens to unused leave beyond the 5-day carryover limit?

Any balance above 5 days is forfeited at year-end unless an exception has been agreed with HR in advance.

Can I take parental leave in more than one block?

Where operationally feasible, leave can be split into agreed blocks within the 12-month window, subject to manager and HR agreement.

Does flextime change my total weekly hours?

No. Flextime adjusts when the 40 weekly hours are worked, not the total, and must be approved by your manager.

Can probation be extended?

The standard probation period is 6 months; any extension would be handled as an exception by HR and the employee's manager.

Non-Compliance & Enforcement

Failure to follow leave request procedures may result in delayed or declined approval. Repeated unapproved absence or failure to maintain agreed working hours will be addressed through Acme Corp's standard performance management process, in line with the employee handbook and applicable employment law.

Example Scenarios

Scenario: Planning a two-week vacation

An employee wants to take two consecutive weeks off in August. They check their accrued balance in the HR Portal, confirm it is sufficient, and submit the request more than two weeks in advance. Their manager reviews team coverage for the period, and the department head approves the request once a handover plan is in place.

Scenario: New parent returning from leave

An employee takes 12 weeks of Parental Leave following the birth of a child, starting the leave two months after the birth. Because this falls within the 12-month window, the leave is approved in full, and HR coordinates the return-to-work date with the employee's manager.

Scenario: Ending employment during probation

A new hire decides, five months into their role, that the position is not the right fit. They provide 1 week's notice as outlined in the probation terms, and HR processes the exit in line with standard offboarding procedures.

Related Policies & Resources

- Employee Handbook — general conduct and workplace expectations
- Performance Management Guidelines — probation and ongoing review process
- Compensation & Benefits Overview — pay, benefits, and leave interactions

Quick Reference — HR Policy

Item	Policy
Working hours	9:00 AM – 5:00 PM, Mon–Fri (40 hrs/week)
Flextime	Manager-approved, subject to department performance
Annual leave entitlement	25 days/year, accrued at 2.08 days/month
Leave request process	HR Portal, min. 2 weeks in advance, dept. head approval
Leave carryover	Maximum 5 unused days into next year
Parental leave	12 weeks fully paid, gender-neutral, within 12 months of event
Probation length	6 months
Probation notice period	1 week, either party

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	July 13, 2026	Initial consolidated publication of the HR policy for the Enterprise Policy Assistant.

This document is the authoritative source for this policy area. In the event of any discrepancy with summaries, training materials, or third-party references, this policy document takes precedence. Questions not addressed here should be directed to the relevant owning department listed under Roles & Responsibilities.